

Problem Description: Task Scheduler with Dependencies

1. Overview

A Python module that computes a valid execution order for tasks with dependencies. Each task is identified by a unique string. A dependency (A, B) means A must complete before B begins. The module returns an ordered list of tasks such that every task appears after all of its dependencies.

1.1 API

```
schedule_tasks(tasks: list[str], dependencies: list[tuple[str, str]]) -> list[str]
```

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
tasks	list[str]	Yes	List of unique task names
dependencies	list[tuple[str, str]]	Yes	Dependency pairs (before_task, after_task)

Returns: list[str] — a valid ordering of all tasks.

Example:

```
tasks = ["fetch_data", "clean_data", "train_model", "evaluate_model"]
dependencies = [("fetch_data", "clean_data"),
                ("clean_data", "train_model"),
                ("train_model", "evaluate_model")]
# Returns: ["fetch_data", "clean_data", "train_model", "evaluate_model"]
```

1.2 Ordering Rules

- Every task in tasks appears exactly once in the returned execution order.
- For every dependency pair (A, B), A appears before B in the output.
- Deterministic output: when multiple tasks are available, the lexicographically smallest is selected first.

```
schedule_tasks(["b", "a", "c"], []) # Returns: ["a", "b", "c"]
```

1.3 Error Handling

Error Type	Condition
ValueError	Duplicate task names
ValueError	Dependency refers to unknown task
ValueError	Circular dependency exists
TypeError	tasks is not a list
TypeError	dependencies is not a list
TypeError	Task name is not a string

TypeError	Dependency is not a pair of strings
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1.4 Boundary Conditions

Condition	Expected Behavior
Empty tasks and dependencies	Return []
Single task, no dependencies	Return [task]
Multiple tasks, no dependencies	Lexicographic order
Long dependency chain	Dependency order
Multiple independent chains	Deterministic via lexicographic availability
Diamond-shaped graph	Downstream after all prerequisites

Diamond example:

```
tasks = ["a", "b", "c", "d"]
dependencies = [("a", "b"), ("a", "c"), ("b", "d"), ("c", "d")]
# Returns: ["a", "b", "c", "d"]
```

1.5 Assumptions

- Standard topological sort is acceptable.
- Task names are case-sensitive.
- Function returns ordering only — does not execute tasks or touch files.
- Expected complexity: $O((N + E) \log N)$ time, $O(N + E)$ space.